

Acme Technologies — Employee Leave Policy 2026

This document sets out the leave entitlements, application procedures, and approval workflows applicable to all full-time and part-time employees of Acme Technologies Private Limited. It supersedes all prior leave policies issued before January 2026. Employees are expected to familiarise themselves with these provisions and to apply for leave through the official HR portal in all cases.

1. Annual Leave

All confirmed full-time employees are entitled to twenty-one days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Annual leave accrues at the rate of one and three-quarter days per completed month of service. Employees who join mid-year receive a pro-rated entitlement calculated from their date of joining. Part-time employees receive annual leave in proportion to their contracted weekly hours.

A maximum of ten unused annual leave days may be carried forward into the following calendar year. Carried-forward days must be consumed before the thirty-first of March, after which they lapse without compensation. Any balance exceeding ten days at the close of the calendar year is forfeited. Employees may not encash unused annual leave except upon separation from the company, where the settlement is calculated at basic salary rate.

Annual leave must be applied for at least ten working days in advance for absences of three days or more, and at least three working days in advance for shorter absences. Applications are subject to approval by the reporting manager, who will consider team coverage, project deadlines, and existing approved absences. Approval is not automatic and may be declined during critical delivery periods, release windows, or financial close.

2. Sick Leave

Employees are entitled to twelve days of paid sick leave per calendar year. Unused sick leave does not carry forward into the following year and is not encashable under any circumstances. Sick leave is intended for genuine illness or injury preventing the employee from performing their duties, and may also be used for medical appointments that cannot reasonably be scheduled outside working hours.

For absences of one or two consecutive days, notification to the reporting manager by telephone or email before the start of the working day is sufficient. For absences of three or more consecutive days, a medical certificate from a registered practitioner must be submitted to the Human Resources department within five working days of returning to work. Failure to submit the required certificate may result in the absence being recorded as unpaid leave.

Employees who exhaust their sick leave entitlement and require further medical absence may apply for extended medical leave, which is considered on a case-by-case basis by the Human Resources department in consultation with the reporting manager and, where appropriate, the company medical adviser. Extended medical leave beyond thirty days may be granted on half pay at the discretion of management.

3. Maternity and Paternity Leave

Eligible female employees are entitled to twenty-six weeks of paid maternity leave for the first two children, and twelve weeks for the third and subsequent children, in accordance with the Maternity Benefit Act. Eligibility requires a minimum of eighty days of service with the company in the twelve months immediately preceding the expected date of delivery.

Maternity leave may commence up to eight weeks before the expected date of delivery. Employees must notify Human Resources of their intended leave dates at least eight weeks in advance, accompanied by a medical certificate confirming the expected date of delivery. The company will continue to pay full salary and maintain all benefits, including medical insurance, throughout the maternity leave period.

Male employees are entitled to fifteen days of paid paternity leave, which must be taken within three months of the date of birth or legal adoption. Paternity leave may be taken in a single block or split into a maximum of three separate periods. Applications should be submitted at least four weeks in advance where the date is foreseeable.

4. Bereavement and Compassionate Leave

Employees are entitled to five days of paid bereavement leave in the event of the death of an immediate family member, defined as a spouse, child, parent, sibling, or parent-in-law. Three days of paid leave are granted for the death of a grandparent, grandchild, or other dependent relative residing in the same household.

Compassionate leave of up to three days per calendar year may be granted at the discretion of the reporting manager for urgent personal or family emergencies that require the employee's immediate presence. Such leave does not require documentation but should be reported to Human Resources upon return. Requests exceeding three days will be considered against the employee's annual leave balance.

5. Unpaid Leave and Sabbaticals

Employees who have exhausted all applicable paid leave entitlements may request unpaid leave. Unpaid leave requires written approval from both the reporting manager and the Head of Human Resources, and is normally limited to thirty days in any rolling twelve-month period. Salary, annual leave accrual, and performance bonus eligibility are suspended for the duration of unpaid leave.

Employees with five or more years of continuous service may apply for a sabbatical of up to three months for purposes of further education, research, or personal development. Sabbatical applications must be submitted at least six months in advance and are granted at the sole discretion of the executive management team, subject to business requirements and the availability of adequate cover.

6. Public Holidays

The company observes twelve public holidays per calendar year, of which ten are fixed and two are floating holidays that employees may schedule at their discretion with manager approval. The list of fixed

holidays is published by Human Resources in December for the following year. Employees required to work on a public holiday due to operational necessity are entitled to compensatory time off to be taken within sixty days.

7. Leave During Notice Period

Employees serving notice following resignation or termination may not take annual leave during the notice period without the express written approval of the Head of Human Resources. Sick leave taken during the notice period requires a medical certificate regardless of duration. Any unused annual leave balance at the conclusion of the notice period will be settled in the final salary payment at basic salary rate.

8. Policy Administration and Review

This policy is administered by the Human Resources department and is reviewed annually. Questions regarding interpretation should be directed to the Human Resources business partner assigned to the employee's function. Any deliberate misrepresentation in a leave application, including the submission of falsified medical documentation, constitutes gross misconduct and may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.